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Adieu

To wrap up my innings I addressed a letter to all commanding officers of battalions, regiments or units and higher command and staff officers of the army on 28 September 2007:

Dear member of the great Indian army team,

I am honoured to have commanded one of the finest armies in the world. As I pass the baton, I wish to place on record my sincere appreciation to all my commanders, commanding officers, staff and the gallant soldiers who helped me uphold the honour, dignity and the professional ethos of our great army. I also pay my solemn tribute to all officers, junior commissioned officers and men who made the supreme sacrifice in the service of our motherland.

I had set out a number of priorities on assuming command in February 2005. These were addressed in right earnest, enabling us to achieve a high level of satisfaction in most areas. I take this opportunity to reminisce with you some of these priority areas, which, with your dedication and unstinted support, have been completed or are in various stages of fructification … (elaborated in earlier chapters).

I am hanging my spurs after forty-three years of responding to the call of the nation through war and peace. You can be sure of my continued association with our glorious organization and with all of you. My commitment to the army will be a lifelong call.

As I hand over the reins of this 'Great Army', I wish you all great success in your future endeavours.

Thank you. God speed and God bless you all.

General J.J. Singh